FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731

REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, making it important to develop a clear concept and use every scene effectively. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms require creativity, planning and effective storytelling.

The project titled “Pendrive ” is a short comedic drama developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course. The story follows a Computer Science and Design student who is working on his academic project late at night. Just as he is preparing to finalise his submission, he realises that the pendrive holding his project file is missing. What begins as a small inconvenience quickly turns into a full-blown, comic panic as he and his roommate tear the room apart searching for it.

The film uses everyday hostel-room chaos — half-packed bags, scattered shelves, a search under the bed — to build humour rather than horror. The tension is resolved with a twist: the file had, in fact, already been safely emailed earlier, and the missing pendrive itself turns out to have been sitting in the roommate's pocket the entire time. The story is designed to be light-hearted while still following the structure of a well-built short film, and it lends itself naturally to being retold as an audio-only radio podcast.

CHAPTER 2

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of Pendrive is to turn a small, relatable inconvenience — a missing storage device — into an exaggerated, comic emergency. The film opens in a completely ordinary setting: a student working on his laptop while his roommate relaxes on the bed. This familiar, low-stakes beginning helps the audience recognise the situation as one they may have lived through themselves.

As the deadline approaches and the pendrive cannot be found, the mood shifts from calm to comic urgency. Bags are emptied, shelves are searched, and both characters begin to blame each other, creating natural comic timing through their contrasting reactions. The eventual realisation that the project file was already submitted by email deflates the panic, and the final reveal — the pendrive falling out of the roommate's pocket as they walk outside — delivers the comic payoff the audience has been waiting for.

The film uses a single hostel room and an adjoining stairwell as its only locations, with two characters and a small set of everyday props such as a laptop, mobile phones, bags and the pendrive itself. This keeps the production simple while still allowing camera work, editing and sound to be used deliberately to build and release comic tension.

CHAPTER 3

TITLE – FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731

The title “Pendrive” refers directly to the small object at the centre of the story's conflict. A pendrive is an ordinary, easily overlooked item, and the film draws its humour from how disproportionate the characters' panic becomes over something so small and so easily misplaced.

The title also carries a light irony that becomes clear only at the end. The object the characters spend the entire film searching for was never actually lost — it had been in the roommate's pocket all along. In this way, “Pendrive” works both as a literal description of the missing object and as a comment on how easily people overlook the obvious when they are caught up in panic.

CHAPTER 4

GENRE

The film belongs to the comedic drama genre. The drama element comes from a situation every student can relate to — the fear of losing important academic work right before a deadline. The comedy is built on top of this relatable stress through exaggerated reactions, physical comedy during the search, and a lighthearted, ironic resolution.

Unlike a suspense-driven thriller, Pendrive does not rely on hidden dangers or unresolved mystery. Instead, its comic energy comes from timing, reaction shots and situational irony. The audience is often one step ahead of the characters, which creates comic anticipation rather than dread — the viewer suspects the pendrive may not really be “lost” long before the characters figure it out.

The major comic elements used in the film are:

- A frantic, escalating search for a small object
- Mutual blame and bickering between roommates
- Exaggerated physical reactions and body language
- A false sense of relief and a second twist
- Dramatic irony — the audience senses the truth before the characters
- A comic reveal as the final punchline

CHAPTER 5

OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging comedic short film using a simple production setup and everyday, relatable events. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera work, editing rhythm and sound can be combined to build and release comic tension, rather than only being used for drama or horror.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an original comedic short-film story.
- To understand screenplay writing and comic timing.
- To practice camera framing for reaction-based humour.
- To use quick, energetic editing to build comic pace.
- To use sound and silence to support comic beats.
- To develop basic video editing and continuity skills.
- To understand the role of background music in comedy.
- To adapt the story into a radio podcast format.
- To understand how visual comedy differs from audio comedy.

CHAPTER 6

STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around a situation that almost every student has experienced in some form — misplacing something important at the worst possible moment. The idea was kept deliberately simple so that the comedy could come from performance and timing rather than from a complicated plot.

The first part of the story establishes the two characters and their contrasting personalities in a normal hostel-room setting: one focused and slightly stressed about his project work, the other relaxed and easily distracted. This contrast becomes the engine of the comedy once the crisis begins.

The middle section was developed to escalate gradually — first a quiet realisation that the pendrive is missing, then a search that grows more chaotic and more physical, and finally a moment of panic as the deadline pressure is voiced aloud. The story then pivots with the discovery that the project file had already been emailed, deflating the tension in a comic way. The final twist — the pendrive dropping out of the roommate's pocket — was developed as the true punchline, rewarding the audience for having quietly suspected the truth all along.

CHAPTER 7

STORY SYNOPSIS

The story follows a Computer Science and Design student who is working late at his desk, putting the finishing touches on his project — a research paper describing a wearable alert system for hearing-impaired parents. His roommate lies nearby on the bed, scrolling through his phone, occasionally glancing over with mild curiosity.

With the submission deadline close, the student reaches for his pendrive to transfer his final files — and cannot find it. What starts as a casual check of his desk quickly turns into a determined search. He digs through his bag, checks the shelves, and moves things around on the table, growing more anxious with every empty pocket and drawer.

Noticing the commotion, his roommate sits up and asks what happened. On hearing that the pendrive is missing, he first reacts with amusement, but soon joins the search himself, questioning where it was last used and teasing his friend for being careless. Their search becomes increasingly frantic and physical — bags are emptied onto the bed, backpacks are shaken out, and both boys begin bumping into each other as they scramble around the small room.

As the panic peaks and the deadline feels dangerously close, the roommate pauses and asks a simple question: did he not already send the file somewhere? The student stops, opens his laptop, and checks his email — and finds that the completed project report had, in fact, already been sent earlier that day as an attachment in a message requesting a plagiarism check. The crisis dissolves into relief and light embarrassment at how worked up they both got over a file that was never actually at risk.

Still without the physical pendrive but no longer worried about it, the two head out of the room and down the stairwell to get some fresh air, laughing off the chaos of the last few minutes. As they step outside into the open air, something small drops out of the roommate's pocket and clatters onto the floor — the missing pendrive. It had been in his pocket the entire time, picked up without either of them realising it. The film ends on this quiet, ironic punchline as the two look at each other in disbelief.

CHAPTER 8

CHARACTERS

The main character is a diligent Computer Science and Design student who is sincere about his project work and becomes visibly anxious when he believes his submission is at risk. His growing panic and physical energy during the search drive most of the film's comic momentum, and his relief and mild embarrassment at the end give the story its warmth.

The second character is his roommate — relaxed, a little distracted, and quicker to joke than to worry. He initially treats the missing pendrive lightly, then genuinely helps in the search, and unknowingly becomes the source of the entire misunderstanding by having the pendrive in his own pocket without realising it. His easy-going nature acts as a comic counterbalance to the main character's stress, and the final reveal recontextualises his casual attitude throughout the film as accidentally, comically responsible for the whole ordeal.

CHAPTER 9

SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – Working at the Desk

The film opens with the main character at his desk, laptop open, working through the final details of his project. The room is calm and ordinary. His roommate lies on the nearby bed, browsing his phone. Medium and wide shots establish the room and the easy, familiar relationship between the two characters.

9.2 Scene 2 – A Quiet Moment Before the Storm

The roommate glances over occasionally, mildly curious about the project work, while the main character continues typing, focused and slightly tense about the approaching deadline. This scene is intentionally low-energy, setting up a contrast for the chaos that follows.

9.3 Scene 3 – Sending the Submission

The main character finalises his work and sends his completed project file by email, attaching it to a message requesting a plagiarism check. This action is shown clearly on screen, planting the detail the audience will need to remember later, even though neither character treats it as significant at the time.

9.4 Scene 4 – Packing Up

As the two prepare to step out, the roommate gathers his things from the bed and floor, casually pocketing small items, including — unnoticed by both characters and the camera's attention — the pendrive. This moment is shot casually, without emphasis, so the audience does not immediately register its importance.

9.5 Scene 5 – The Missing Pendrive

The main character reaches for his pendrive to make a final backup and cannot find it. His expression shifts from mild confusion to concern. He begins checking the desk, then his bag, with growing urgency.

9.6 Scene 6 – The Panic Search

The search escalates quickly. Both characters empty bags onto the bed, dig through shelves, and move around the small room bumping into furniture and each other. Quick, handheld camera movement and fast cuts are used here to heighten the comic chaos.

9.7 Scene 7 – Blame and Bickering

As the search continues without success, the characters begin lightly blaming each other — the main character accusing his roommate of misplacing it, the roommate insisting he never touched it. Their exaggerated arguing adds to the comic tension while the clock keeps ticking.

9.8 Scene 8 – The Realisation

At the height of the panic, the roommate pauses and asks whether the file was not already sent somewhere. The main character stops, opens his laptop, and checks his sent mail — finding the completed project already emailed earlier. The panic breaks into relief and laughter at their own overreaction.

9.9 Scene 9 – Down the Stairs and the Final Reveal

Relieved, the two head out of the room and down the stairwell towards the open air outside, still laughing about the chaos. As they step out under the open sky, the pendrive falls out of the roommate's pocket and clatters onto the floor. Both characters freeze, look at it, then at each other — delivering the film's final comic punchline before the screen cuts to black.

CHAPTER 10

CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax occurs in two connected beats. The first is the false resolution — the discovery that the project file was already safely emailed, which releases the tension built up during the search. The second, and true, climax is the final reveal of the pendrive falling from the roommate's pocket, which recontextualises the entire search as unnecessary and reveals the roommate as the unwitting cause of the whole ordeal.

The ending is left as a light, open moment of shared disbelief rather than a neatly explained conclusion — the audience is trusted to enjoy the irony without further comment from the characters. This mirrors real-life moments of comic anticlimax, where the resolution to a crisis turns out to be far simpler, and far more embarrassing, than the panic that preceded it.

CHAPTER 11

CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography in Pendrive is used to mirror the emotional rhythm of the story. The opening scenes use steady, normal shots to establish a calm, ordinary hostel-room atmosphere. As the search begins, the camera work becomes noticeably more energetic — handheld movement, quick reframing, and closer shots on hands digging through bags and shelves communicate urgency and comic chaos.

Close-up shots are used for reaction faces during the panic and for the laptop screen during the email realisation, since these small details carry the story's key information. The final scene uses a wider, calmer shot as the characters walk down the stairwell and outside, before a quick cut to a close shot of the pendrive hitting the floor for maximum comic impact.

CHAPTER 12

LIGHTING

The lighting throughout most of the film is natural, everyday room lighting, keeping the tone light and grounded rather than moody. This is appropriate for a comedy, where heavy shadows or dramatic lighting would work against the intended tone.

The final scene transitions from the dimmer interior of the room and stairwell to bright, open daylight outside. This shift in lighting visually reinforces the emotional release of the story — moving from an enclosed, anxious space into the open air just before the final comic twist.

CHAPTER 13

SOUND DESIGN

Sound plays a key role in selling the comedy of Pendrive. Everyday sounds — keyboard typing, a phone notification, zippers being pulled open, bags being emptied — establish the realistic setting and later intensify as the search becomes more frantic.

A short, comic musical sting or a quickened rhythm track can be used to underline the panic during the search, while the sound suddenly softening or pausing during the email-realisation scene helps land that beat. The final moment relies on a single, clear sound effect — the light clatter of the pendrive hitting the floor — which should be given a small, dedicated beat of near-silence beforehand to make the payoff land clearly.

Important sound elements include:

- Keyboard typing
- Email notification sound
- Zippers and bags being unpacked
- Footsteps and shuffling during the search
- Comic musical stings
- Laughter and overlapping dialogue
- Footsteps on the stairwell
- The pendrive dropping and clattering on the floor

CHAPTER 14

EDITING TECHNIQUES

Editing is central to how the comedy in Pendrive lands. The calm opening scenes use longer, unhurried cuts, while the search sequence uses quick, rhythmic jump cuts between the two characters and different parts of the room to build comic momentum.

A brief montage style — short cuts of bags being opened, shelves being checked, and pockets being patted down — helps compress the search into an energetic sequence without slowing the film down. The realisation scene uses a slower cut and a held shot on the laptop screen to let the audience read the email alongside the character. The final reveal benefits from a short pause or near-freeze before cutting to the pendrive on the floor, giving the punchline a clean comic beat.

CHAPTER 15

USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The project is designed to be produced using a simple hostel room and an adjoining stairwell, both easily accessible locations. The limited setting keeps production simple while still allowing for a variety of shots and comic staging.

The major props required are:

- Laptop
- Pendrive
- Mobile phones
- Backpacks and bags
- Study table and chair
- Beds and bedding
- Staircase leading outside

The small number of props keeps the focus on the performances and comic timing of the two characters rather than on production complexity.

CHAPTER 16

RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

The same story can be adapted into a radio podcast by replacing visual comedy with audio cues and dialogue-driven humour. In the film, the audience sees the characters frantically emptying bags and searching shelves; in the podcast, this must be communicated through sound effects — rustling bags, objects being moved, a chair scraping — combined with fast, overlapping dialogue between the two characters.

The visual reveal of the pendrive falling from the roommate's pocket cannot be shown in audio form, so it must be replaced with a clear, unmistakable sound effect — the pendrive hitting the floor — followed by a beat of silence and a reaction line from one of the characters. This demonstrates how a visual punchline must be redesigned as an audio one for the podcast medium to work.

CHAPTER 17

RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast version can open with a short narrated description of the setting — a hostel room, late morning — accompanied by the sound of typing. When the main character discovers the pendrive is missing, his dialogue should shift into quicker, more clipped sentences to convey urgency without visuals.

During the search, overlapping dialogue between the two characters, combined with sound effects of bags and shelves being searched, can recreate the chaotic energy of the visual scene. The email realisation can be marked by a distinct notification sound and a pause in the dialogue, letting the audience register the shift in tone before the characters speak again.

The ending should slow the pace slightly as the characters walk outside, footsteps and open-air ambience signalling the change in location, before the final sound of the pendrive dropping delivers the punchline. A short beat of silence before the last line allows the joke to land clearly for a listening audience.

CHAPTER 18

VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice acting carries the entire comic tone of the podcast version, since the audience cannot see facial expressions or physical comedy. The main character's voice should move from focused and calm to increasingly anxious and fast-paced as the search intensifies, then relax into relief once the email is found.

The roommate's voice should remain comparatively light and amused throughout, providing a comic contrast to the main character's rising panic. This contrast should be maintained even into the final scene, so that his casual tone right up to the reveal makes the twist land with more irony.

The following elements are important:

- Clear, energetic pacing during the panic sequence
- Distinct vocal contrast between the two characters
- Comic timing in pauses and interruptions
- A believable shift from anxiety to relief
- Light background music to support comic beats
- Effective use of silence before the final punchline

CHAPTER 19

PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of the project can be divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production.

During pre-production, the situational idea was developed into a simple screenplay, and the two characters, single room location, stairwell and small prop list were finalised. The escalation of the search and the placement of the two twists — the email discovery and the pendrive reveal — were planned in advance to control the comic pacing.

During production, the scenes were recorded within the hostel room and along the adjoining stairwell. Multiple takes of the search sequence were captured to allow flexibility in editing for comic timing, and the laptop screen was recorded separately where needed for the email scene.

During post-production, the footage was reviewed and cut together, with particular attention paid to the rhythm of the search montage and the timing of the final reveal. Sound effects, comic musical stings and any required text or screen overlays were added before the final video was exported.

CHAPTER 20

CHALLENGES FACED

One of the main challenges in producing a comedy with a simple setup is achieving natural comic timing without over-rehearsing the performances, since forced comedy can easily feel unconvincing on camera.

Keeping the search sequence energetic without letting it run too long was another challenge, requiring careful trimming during editing so that the chaos stays entertaining rather than repetitive.

Coordinating the final reveal was also demanding — the pendrive needed to fall naturally and be captured clearly on camera, and the reaction shots needed to be timed precisely against the sound of it hitting the floor for the punchline to land effectively.

CHAPTER 21

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical skills were developed, including screenplay writing for comedy, scene planning, camera operation, comic acting, sound recording and video editing.

The project also demonstrated the importance of pacing and rhythm in comic storytelling — a joke can be strengthened or weakened entirely depending on how a scene is cut and how long a pause is held before the punchline.

The radio podcast adaptation provided additional experience in voice acting and audio editing for comedy, and highlighted how a visual gag must be reimagined as a distinct, well-placed sound cue in order to work for a listening audience.

CHAPTER 22

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The final outcome of the project is a short comedic drama titled Pendrive, supported by a radio podcast adaptation of the same story. The film is expected to engage the audience through a relatable, everyday crisis that escalates into comic chaos before resolving in an ironic, satisfying punchline.

The project demonstrates the practical use of visual storytelling, comic timing, sound design and editing rhythm, while its light-hearted tone and student-life setting are intended to make it easy for a college audience to connect with and enjoy.

CHAPTER 23

CONCLUSION

The Pendrive project demonstrates how a small, everyday inconvenience can be developed into an engaging comedic short film through careful pacing, performance and editing. The story begins with an ordinary night of project work and builds into a lighthearted panic over a missing pendrive, before resolving with a comic twist that recontextualises everything that came before it.

The project combines screenplay writing, comic acting, cinematography, sound design and editing, with each element working together to build and release tension for comic effect rather than suspense. The use of a single location and just two characters also shows that effective comedy, like effective drama, does not require elaborate production resources.

The radio podcast adaptation further demonstrates how comic storytelling must be reshaped for an audio-only medium, replacing visual gags with sound effects, pacing and vocal performance.

Overall, Pendrive provides practical experience in both film making and radio podcasting while demonstrating the importance of timing, irony and audience anticipation in comic storytelling.

"Sometimes, what you're frantically searching for was with you all along."